Short case study

Don't fall into the scope trap of identifying the scope of DG with size or market dominance. You need to rationally consider influencing factors we have presented; that is the business model, the assets to be managed, and what type of federation is required. Using Fig. 4.2 again, let's assume it represents a global retail organization, with many brands, but the same distribution and merchandising network.

Business model—the business model is global, with heavy dependence on economy of scale across the supply chain. So, our scope will lean toward the entire organization—we will not be excluding any functions, like merchandising or warehouse.

Content being managed—obviously there is a lot of content in a large organization, but consider the variety—retail is, at its core, pretty simple. You buy stuff from one place and sell it to someone else. The main content is anything used or descriptive of the "stuff" and getting it sold. Be careful—it isn't just the items—what about the people on the sales floor? What about the trucks and trains to move items about? All are integral to the business. So from a scope standpoint we need to consider almost all of the content within this type of enterprise. The key guidance to apply is—the scope of DG is a function of the assets being managed (i.e., the content and information being governed).

Federation—the entire enterprise is in scope, and all content relevant to the business model is in scope. We have not narrowed this down much, have we? When we examine the content (remember we are considering all of it), we see that it stratifies into global, regional, and local. This is significant. If a region or locality can buy items to sell, what is the intensity of DG in those supply chains versus the global ones? We have to consider that local data may not be worth close governance and may be okay with a more relaxed level of intensity.

Bottom line: All content is in scope, but due to size, geography, and markets, we need to consciously identify which specific content is managed centrally, regionally, or locally. The organization would state that DG scope is all content relevant to the business model, but the intensity of DG will vary based on a specifically defined set of federated layers.

Elements of data governance programs

In many ways, a DG program is like any other business program. Many elements of DG make perfect sense to businesspersons when they first consider DG. For some reason, the people on the technology side of the information management and DG equation get dazed and confused. Either way, this section will introduce these basic program elements in the context of DG. We then will review the important, managerial aspects of these elements. Later on, we will get into the specific design and deployment of each of these elements.

DG is simple in its makeup. There are the three cornerstones of any organization—People, Process, and Technology. On top of that, we need to add the newest, permanent cornerstone and aspect of any program—Data. (Do not stop at the People, Process, Technology mantra—you MUST add data).

The People-aspect deals with the various required roles. Process needs to cover an operating model and the capabilities required to operate DG. Technology covers DG-specific technologies. The Data element covers the actual content, metadata, catalogs, all content, data dictionaries, etc.

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Because we are answering the "What does it look like?" question, let's briefly cover the Process element first.

Process—The DG operating model

The DG operating model is made up of two components: the capabilities model, which states WHAT is happening, and the workflow model, which dictates how information flows and parties interact within the program, and how decisions are made.

Essential capabilities

A capabilities approach has become more popular for addressing DG functionality over the years. It is familiar. The basic approach to standing up DG is handled like standing up any other new business capability or upgrading current capabilities to include better data behaviors. We use the term capability to describe the "what" has to happen in DG. Because it is programmatic, DG introduces new capabilities to the organization.

Capabilities are also much more stable than processes or functions. Since DG is a long-term alteration in data operations, it makes sense to be more stable. In a world where agility is important, capability-based design allows iterations more easily, since your target is putting in stable capabilities vs a specific process tied to a policy.

Initially these functions will appear to be embedded in the DG "area" but over time they need to evolve into day-to-day activities within all areas. Using the word "process" would immediately imply a "where," and that is an operational level of detail that evolves. Within the capabilities are functions and activities that will be visible in the DG management framework as stand-alone processes as well as the day-to-day activities that carry out governance. There is no need to design your DG functional model from scratch; there is a list later in the book. However, recognizing that there will be a formal set of functional requirements (to be manifested as processes) and that they will be executed all the time is a key element to the success of DG. Capabilities perform two roles. First, they point out what someone actually must do. Second, reviewing the functions required for your organization usually aids in determining which areas or individuals would bear accountability and responsibility.

The DG area will need to consider other business areas where there will be interaction and collaboration, such as:

- Human resources
- Compliance and/or legal
- Risk management
- Large-scale integration projects, such as enterprise resource planning

The bottom line for this element of DG is that you need to formally consider and build the DG processes and functions. They are not instinctive.

In the first edition I called out FUNCTIONS to indicate the WHAT. However, "Capabilities" fits better. Lastly, this is the language of enterprise architecture, and over the past years I have noticed it is easier to get DG engaged with enterprise architects, as well as the usual constituents. Table 4.1 shows a very high-level representation of DG capabilities.

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Table 4.1 High-level data governance capabilities

High level data governance capabilities
Data and governance strategy
Data governance requirements and design
Data governance frameworks
Supporting technology
Data governance operation
Data governance engagement
Data governance measurements
Technology operation
Communication
Training
Data governance services
Sustaining design
Sustaining activity management
Sustaining program operation

Work flow

Like any other activity within a company or government entity, there needs to be a formal statement of work flow. Please note that this is no hint to design an organization chart. Rarely does DG activity become a stand-alone area (i.e., there is rarely a DG "department").

Work will flow within DG like other forms of governance. In lieu of an organization chart, consider DG structure to be more of a matrix. This allows incredible flexibility (Table 4.2).

Table 4.2 Data governance as work flow

	Management	Operations
Strategic activity	Set strategy, align to business, provide principles, ultimate issue resolution	Specify controls, metrics
Tactical activity	Identify issues, offer coaching, support application of policy	Provide DG services, operate supporting technology, provide training and communications

Perhaps the best way to see DG capabilities in action is to look at a common artifact from an active DG program—a meeting agenda for the main DG council. The council represents a group that gets the governing done (Fig. 4.3).

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Council Agenda Planning				March 1, 20nn
Month:	**March 7th**	**CURRENT AGENDA**		
Presenter	Topic	Item	Duration	Action required
	Orientation	Charter ratification discussion	10	Understand role of the Data Governance Council (DGC)
		Principles and policy introduction	20	Understand role of principles and policies
	DG Value	Recommended DG metrics	5	Understand role of metrics to measure DG and review proposed measures for DG
		DG scorecard introduction	10	Review current DG scorecard
	DG Compliance	Principles and policy roll-out	15	Determine / approve principle / policy roll out
		Status of classification policy and efforts		Awareness of effort and business impacts
	DG Process	DGC meeting protocol	10	Define meeting protocol
	Issues	Custodian training	20	Trial issue—Review and recommend resolution
			90	
Month:	**April 3rd**	**FUTURE AGENDA**		
Presenter	Topic	Item	Duration	Action required
	DG Process	DGC meeting protocol, rules of order	10	Define meeting protocol
	Orientation	Education—Role of DG	10	Undertand role of principles and policies
		Demystifying policy presentation	10	Undertand policy hierarchy
		Sample DG scenarios currently underway	15	Undertand what is going on
	DG Roll-out	Crawl, walk, run approach	15	Review and adjust/approve DGC “road map”
	DG Value	Short term objectives—walk the talk	15	Leave with consistent identity and message
			65	

FIG. 4.3

Sample data governance agenda

Helpful hint

Remember that the ultimate goal of DG is to disappear as a stand-alone program. It becomes part of the fabric of business, like financial controls. That is why the DG “department” is really a monitoring structure—much like an audit committee. To be more specific, DG may not really

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